

them. There are several ways to split files. You can use a file-splitting utility such as HJSplit (www.freebyte.com/hjsplit/) where you simply have to specify which file is to be split and how large each piece should be. The files can be joined back to the original using the same utility. However, this means that the person you are sending the files to should have the same utility (you could include it on one of the floppies). Another way of splitting files is to use a compression program such as WinZip or WinRAR. Almost all compression programs allow you to split the output file into multiple files of a particular size, which can later be joined back together. You can make a self-extracting archive so that the program does not need to be installed anywhere else.

You can use a service such as Yahoo! Briefcase (briefcase.yahoo.com) to store your files. This allows you to store up to 30 MB of data, with a maximum limit of 1 MB per file. You can share these Web folders with your friends for them to download the files.

I wish dad was here to celebrate Sunita's second birthday. But he won't be coming to India before Diwali.

Today, you can share all your magic moments with your friends and family, with several options available on the Net. You can scan photographs, group them into albums and put them up on the Web for others to see.

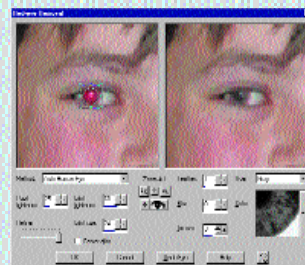
Contrary to popular belief, you don't need to know a thing about making Web sites for this. There are several services that create photo albums for you—all you need to do is select the photos from your PC. Both, Yahoo! and MSN provide free photo albums online. You can send out an e-mail to your kith and kin with links to the photographs and they can see them from anywhere in the world. Some services such as Ofoto (www.ofoto.com) even allow visitors to order prints. Thus, if they see a photograph they like, the site will have it printed out on photo-quality paper and mail it to them! For more details on how to share your photographs online, refer to Digit, August 2002.

I often end up red-eyed in my photographs. How do I touch them up?

Often, photographs may need some digital imaging to look better, regardless of whether they've been taken through an analogue or digital camera. Typical corrections include removing the red eye effect (you may have noticed that the eyes of people in many photographs have a red spot), changing brightness and contrast settings and smoothening or sharpening the images. The latter enhancements are pretty straightforward and can be done with most image editing software, but removing the red eye effect usually gets to be a problem. Red eye occurs when the camera flash reflects off the subject's retina since the pupils are wide open because you're shooting in

low light. It also commonly happens with contact lens users.

There are thousands of image-editing tools with which you can add various effects to your images. The



Removing the red eye effect

easiest way to eliminate the red eye is by using an automatic red eye tool, if your image editor has it. Paint Shop Pro (www.jasc.com) has a great semi-automated process for eliminating the red eye effect. Start by opening a photo you want to work on. From the Paint Shop Pro menu, click **Effects > Enhance Photo > Red-Eye Removal**. On the Red-Eye Removal dialog box, zoom in to the eye. Set the Method to Auto Human Eye and select an appropriate hue and colour. On the editing window, use the selection tool to draw a circle to cover the red portion. Similarly, select the other eye and click OK on the Red-Eye Removal dialog box to apply the changes.

If you're using an image editor that doesn't have a red eye remover, there are still a few ways to tackle the problem. For instance, you can use the Magic Wand tool to select the red in each eye and then paint the selections

a colour that looks natural for that subject. Another way is to use the Paintbrush tool. Resize it till it is just about the size of the eye. Set the foreground colour to the natural eye colour and click once in the centre of the eye. Now set the brush size to about two pixels and change the foreground colour to white. Again, click in the centre of the eye to give it a glint.

Note that you don't have to do a perfect job to create a fairly convincing eye—the detail is so small in most pictures that simply eliminating most of the red is enough to improve the picture.

The online photo albums are nice, but I want to profile something more. How can I quickly create my own Web site?

There are various sites that allow free Web hosting. Not only can you put up your own pages on the site, but most of them also have cool templates and wizards that allow you to create pages in just a few clicks, without requiring any knowledge of creating Web pages at all. Yahoo! Geocities (www.geocities.yahoo.com) is one such free service where you can build a free Web site.

If you don't want the automatic or template-based sites, you can still create your own site fairly easily. Web development tools today are no different from word processing tools. In fact, you can use

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